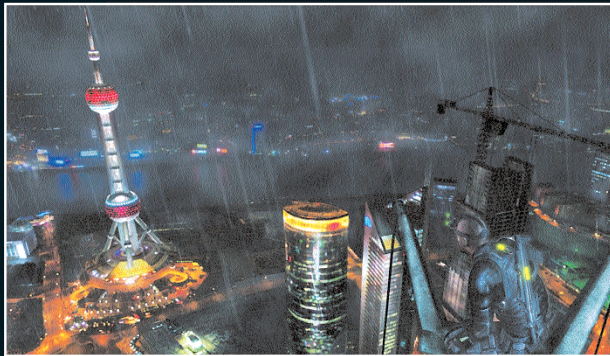




# Brilliant. Twice

The maestro of stealth is back as Sam Fisher returns for a fourth innings. This time it's Fisher getting (surprisingly) locked away for hitting the ceiling owing to some terrible news and subsequently hitting something else (no spoilers). The jail thing turns out to be a setup, as Fisher's incarceration was planned by the NSA. Turns out all this is done to get him into the good books of the JBA (John Brown's Army), a heavily-armed terrorist group.

Escaping along side a JBA agent plus Sam's own considerable skills means the JBA accept Fisher into their ranks, his loyalty unquestioned. But he's still an NSA operative. So throughout *Double Agent* you'll be given missions from both parties. Complete missions from the JBA and they trust you more. Lose trust of any one party completely and your game's over. Some objectives later on will conflict, so you need to juggle around priorities a bit. A couple of significant gameplay changes—no health kits, Sam recovers health automatically when not in combat. Secondly



there's no stealth meter, you'll have to watch the lights and shadows around you.

The missions are (thankfully) varied, as are the locales Fisher visits. However, on the whole, there's nothing in the way of path-breaking differences between *Double Agent* and earlier versions, except for the trust factor, which does add depth to the gameplay, if not replayability.

Graphics still look much the business some four years after the first game; brilliant use of HDR and shadows and gorgeous textures will make upgrading to a new graphics card worth every rupee! The aural engine is right up there, with voice acting to match. Enemy AI is sharp, but I hardly noticed any changes over *Chaos Theory*. Multiplayer has been spruced up.

Overall, *Double Agent* delivers the goods doing everything that the previous three games in the series did, with a little extra. One downside is the system requirements, which aren't as forgiving as the earlier versions. If you have a beefy rig, however, nothing should stop you from picking this one up.

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